

TSANGAI BUSINESS GROWTH SERIES · #05

# The AI Business Tech Stack

The only five tools a service business actually needs — in the right order, at the right price, with nothing you'll regret buying.

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## WHO IT'S FOR

Owners drowning in tool recommendations and free-trial fatigue

## TIME REQUIRED

15 minutes

## WHAT YOU'LL ACHIEVE

Your complete stack chosen, budgeted, and layer one set up today

## EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

# You don't have a tool problem. You have a too-many-tools problem.

Five layers cover 95% of what a service business needs from AI. This cheat sheet names each layer, when to add it, and what to pay — so you stop collecting subscriptions and start compounding time savings.

*I've audited businesses paying for eleven AI tools and using one. The stack that works is boring: one assistant, one notetaker, one automation hub, one content engine, one CRM layer. Added in order, one at a time, each earning its keep before the next arrives.*

— Ray, TsangAI Consulting

## WHY THIS MATTERS

### 5 tools

Layers that cover 95% of a service business's AI needs

### <\$150

Typical monthly cost for the full stack, per person

### 1 at a time

Add a layer only after the last one is a daily habit

## THE ONE IDEA

### Build in layers, not in shopping sprees.

Tools compound when each one feeds the next: your notetaker feeds your assistant, your assistant feeds your automations. Bought all at once, they just compete for your attention and lose.

**Example:** A consultant started with just ChatGPT (layer 1) for a month, then added a meeting notetaker (layer 2). Now every client call auto-becomes notes, a follow-up email, and a task list — a system, not a pile of apps.

## YOUR 10-MINUTE QUICK WIN

- ☐ Read the five-layer table on page 4
- ☐ Circle the one layer you're missing that hurts most
- ☐ Set up layer 1 today if you haven't: a paid AI assistant
- ☐ Cancel one AI subscription you haven't opened in 30 days

## Five layers, added in order

### 1 The Assistant — your AI home base

ChatGPT or Claude, paid tier. This is where drafts, ideas, and decisions happen. If you only ever do one thing, do this.

**Do this:** Subscribe (~\$20/mo), pin it as your first browser tab, use it daily for two weeks.

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### 2 The Notetaker — never scribble in meetings again

Tools like Fathom, Otter, or Fireflies join your calls and deliver notes, action items, and summaries automatically.

**Do this:** Connect it to your calendar. Let it join every call for one week, then read the summaries.

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### 3 The Automation Hub — connect your apps

n8n, Zapier, or Make moves data between your tools while you sleep: form fills become CRM entries, invoices trigger reminders.

**Do this:** Build one automation only: "new lead → instant reply + notification to me."

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### 4 The Content Engine — one idea becomes ten posts

Your assistant plus a scheduler (Buffer, Later, or similar). Record one voice memo, turn it into a week of posts and an email.

**Do this:** Use Prompt Pack guide #04 to repurpose one client conversation into three posts.

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### 5 The Smart CRM — follow-ups that never slip

A simple CRM (HubSpot free tier works) with AI drafting your follow-ups. Leads stop dying in your inbox.

**Do this:** Import your last 20 leads. Set one rule: every lead gets a follow-up within 24 hours.

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#### COMMON MISTAKES

### This is where most business owners get stuck.

They buy layer 3 tools before layer 1 habits exist. They chase every new tool launch instead of mastering a boring stack. And they judge tools in a weekend instead of a two-week real-work trial.

#### PRO TIP

Put a monthly "stack audit" in your calendar: every tool must name the hours it saved that month. Can't answer? It's cancelled. A five-tool stack you use beats a fifteen-tool stack you pay for.

# The stack table + your budget worksheet

## The Five-Layer Stack

| # | LAYER          | WHAT IT DOES                              | EXAMPLE TOOLS            | ~COST/MO |
|---|----------------|-------------------------------------------|--------------------------|----------|
| 1 | Assistant      | Drafts, decisions, daily thinking partner | ChatGPT, Claude          | \$20     |
| 2 | Notetaker      | Meeting notes, action items, summaries    | Fathom, Otter, Fireflies | \$0–20   |
| 3 | Automation hub | Moves data between apps automatically     | n8n, Zapier, Make        | \$0–30   |
| 4 | Content engine | Turns one idea into a week of content     | Assistant + Buffer/Later | \$0–20   |
| 5 | Smart CRM      | Tracks leads, drafts follow-ups           | HubSpot, Pipedrive       | \$0–50   |

## My Stack Worksheet

| LAYER      | MY TOOL | \$/MO |
|------------|---------|-------|
| Assistant  | _____   | ____  |
| Notetaker  | _____   | ____  |
| Automation | _____   | ____  |
| Content    | _____   | ____  |
| CRM        | _____   | ____  |
| Total      |         | ____  |

Sanity check: total under \$150/person? Good. Over?  
Something's overlapping.

## The Stack Advisor Prompt

You are a no-hype software advisor for small service businesses. My business: [WHAT YOU DO], team of [N], budget [\$X]/month. I already use: [CURRENT TOOLS]. Using the 5-layer stack (assistant, notetaker, automation hub, content engine, smart CRM), tell me: which layers I already have covered, which single layer to add next and why, the specific cheapest tool for it, and what to cancel because it overlaps.

## Before You Buy — the 4 Checks

- ✓ Does it replace hours, not just look cool?
- ✓ Does it connect to what I already use?
- ✓ Can I test the real thing free for 14 days?
- ✓ Will my least techy person actually use it?

## CONTINUE YOUR JOURNEY

# Your stack is chosen. Here's what's next.

One step at a time. No pressure, no pitch — just the next most useful thing.

### STEP 1 · WATCH

#### My exact stack, on screen, end to end

See all five layers working together in a real business.

[YouTube link]



### STEP 2 · JOIN

#### The TsangAI Skool Community

Free community of service business owners using AI to buy back their time.

[Skool link]



### STEP 3 · TALK

#### Book a Discovery Call

30 minutes. Zero pressure. Walk away with a custom game plan.

## LET'S TALK

# Want your stack designed for you?

On a free 30-minute discovery call, I'll review your current tools, cut what overlaps, and map the exact stack for your business and budget. Zero fluff; you'll walk away with a custom game plan.

**Book my discovery call →**

[calendly.com/raymondtsang-ai](https://calendly.com/raymondtsang-ai)

## TSANGAI BUSINESS GROWTH SERIES

☐ #01 Business AI Scorecard

☐ #02 Buy Back 10 Hours Every Week

☐ #03 AI Opportunity Finder

☐ #04 AI Prompt Starter Pack

☒ **#05 AI Business Tech Stack (this guide)**

☐ #06 Automation Playbook